

Site B, Instructor Interview 1

Interviewer: [0:00:01.0] [colleague] told me that was the big thing not to forget.

Gillian: [0:00:05.0] Yes. That's a horrible thing. You get home when you find it. Oh, gosh.

Interviewer: [0:00:10.0] I know. So I wanted to make sure she, she wrote it on there for me ask to record. So. Okay. First question, can you tell me about the course you teach? Why [Introduction to Qualitative Research]?

Gillian: [0:00:23.0] Sure. It's an introductory class in qualitative methods. It's a graduate level class. And very often people come in to it. I mean, people come from a lot of different departments and things and they often, it's very often the first class in qualitative methods. Or sometimes I might be wrong about this, but I think it tends to be people who want to, you know, take it fairly lightly. They don't want to do this [qualitative methodology course A and qualitative methodology course B] thing.

Interviewer: [0:00:56.0] Yeah.

Gillian: But sometimes it'll be someone who has, who wants all the qualitative methods they can get. So it's sort of like there's a spectrum of people in class. But and I also teach it online and in the online classes, it tends to be more people who aren't particularly familiar with qualitative methods. Again, I might be wrong, but.

Interviewer: [0:01:21.0] Do you have, is it. Oh, it's my next question.

Gillian: [0:01:25.0] No, it's fine. Yeah. Anyway, it's so it's an introductory course on qualitative methods and. It's fun. It's. I don't know. I like it, I've taught it for a long time.

Interviewer: [0:01:39.0] How long have you taught it for?

Gillian: [0:01:40.0] I was an adjunct for [several] years. So, I've taught it since spring [over 10 years].

Interviewer: [0:01:48.0] Oh, wow. That is a long time.

Gillian: [0:01:50.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: Have you seen it change at all?

Gillian: [0:01:52.0] Oh, yeah. All the time, it changes every semester.

Interviewer: [0:01:55.0] Every semester.

Gillian: Every semester. I realize. Oh, my Gosh, I did that all wrong.

Interviewer: [0:02:00.0] Oh, I bet that's a long time. That's pretty beautiful, though, to be able to watch its progression.

Gillian: [0:02:07.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: That's cool. That's like [year]. That's what is it, [estimates age of course development]? I think of it in. The form of a child. You know, it's in its adolescent years now.

Gillian: [0:02:19.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:02:22.0] Okay, would you mind describing the typical students who attend this course? You started to.

Gillian: [0:02:27.0] I sort of started to. It's very difficult, actually, since I became a [faculty position]. This is way too much identifying information here because anyway, since I became a [faculty position], I get a lot more students who have attended my [research methodology course B] or [research methodology course A] and who want to come in and do because I know them already. So but let's.

Interviewer: [0:02:52.0] See.

Interviewer: [0:02:53.0] So they're following for you basically

Gillian: [0:02:56.0] Some, some are.

Interviewer: Which I get, I've done. You know, someone takes, I love [Gillian]. I'll take another one of [Gillian's] classes.

Gillian: [0:03:04.0] I don't know that there is a typical student, I. Um, I think in the beginning, especially when I was an adjunct and had more online classes, I would get more people who were unfamiliar, and I had to sort of talk them into the idea that the research actually was a thing and not an oxymoron and not sort of a bunch of anecdotes. So in the early years, I got in the habit of explaining that over and over again, you know, that this is real, this is something valid. It is, you know, and that was and really, I think maybe I've overdone that in the last few years where often that students come in already kind of thinking that it's a valuable approach.

Interviewer: [0:03:49.0] So.

[0:03:50.0] The times have changed. They've started breathing in qualitative research.

Interviewer: [0:03:54.0] Ahead of time.

Gillian: [0:03:55.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:03:56.0] Which is appreciated.

Gillian: [0:03:57.0] Yeah. But I've, I don't know, they're lovely people. Usually I get quite a lot of international students.

Interviewer: [0:04:05.0] Okay.

Gillian: I get a big variety of students and they're all my favorites. I mean, they're they're very delightful, mostly.

[0:04:12.0] to [0:04:50.0]: [redacted]

Interviewer: [0:04:50.0] Do you have any like, do you notice any more school, like psychology students or anything like that? Or is it really just like all over the board?

Gillian: [0:04:57.0] It's really all over the board. I tend to notice more what countries people come from than what their program is, which is, I don't know.

Interviewer: [0:05:07.0] Well, different knowledge sets. Right?

Gillian: [0:05:09.0] Right, right, right.

Interviewer: Because that's huge. Like culturally, our knowledge set is very specific. I noticed.

Gillian: [0:05:15.0] Yes. So. Right. Yes.

Interviewer: [0:05:17.0] [Professor's] class again thinking in, the others that I am meeting with.

Gillian: [0:05:23.0] Yes, yes.

Interviewer: [0:05:25.0] I was like, oh, do you notice if any of them like are like check the box students? Like, Oh, that's my qualitative class.

Gillian: [0:05:33.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay.

Gillian: But that was again a bit more in the earlier years, especially with online classes, maybe?

Interviewer: [0:05:42.0] That makes sense.

Gillian: [0:05:43.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:05:44.0] And you teach every semester? Do you teach this course?

Gillian: [0:05:48.0] Yeah, pretty much. I don't teach it in summer.

Interviewer: [0:05:52.0] And then is it online and in person every semester. Or?

Gillian: [0:05:56.0] I think I'm getting moo, it's so messed up the last few years because of the pandemic.

Interviewer: [0:06:01.0] Yeah.

Gillian: So for a while everything was online and then for the last year I just thought people must be kind of desperate for face to face. And I was desperate for face to face. So I've done everything face to face this academic year.

Interviewer: [0:06:16.0] Yeah, I am.

Interviewer: [0:06:17.0] I can't do

Gillian: [0:06:18.0] And I don't even remember what was normal before. I think I used to teach one online [Introduction to Qualitative Research] here.

Interviewer: [0:06:26.0] But it's funny I don't know.

Gillian: I know I taught, I taught at least one face to face so I, I don't remember.

Interviewer: [0:06:31.0] I know I don't remember.

Gillian: [0:06:32.0] Okay.

Interviewer: [0:06:34.0] What for either. I'm like what was life before pandemic.

Gillian: [0:06:38.0] I know.

Interviewer: Because it's not going back to that.

Gillian: [0:06:39.0] It's a long time ago.

Interviewer: [0:06:40.0] Yeah. And it's not going to like things aren't going to be the same. I don't think so.

Gillian: [0:06:44.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:06:45.0] But yeah no I, I am so happy to be in person, I can't do online very well. It's my brain, it just floats away. It's hard for me on a computer because I'm not.

Gillian: [0:06:58.0] It's like,

Interviewer: [0:06:59.0] In person.

Gillian: Yeah, a computer is to me it's like work. And if it's all computer, it's just like all work instead of people.

Interviewer: [0:07:05.0] Yeah, because I find.

Interviewer: [0:07:07.0] If I leave a zoom class, I'm exhausted. If I leave an in-person class, I am rejuvenated.

Gillian: [0:07:15.0] Interesting.

Interviewer: Like I have more energy, I've engaged in discussion, and that doesn't mean that the discussion has changed much.

Gillian: [0:07:20.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: But there's something about in person that I feel like I'm ready to go out into the world.

Gillian: [0:07:26.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:07:27.0] Whereas Zoom, I'm ready to go.

Gillian: [0:07:29.0] Ready to shut it and crawl into a corner.

Interviewer: [0:07:31.0] So I completely agree.

Gillian: [0:07:34.0] Okay.

Interviewer: [0:07:36.0] So. I almost said all that to say because [colleague] has influenced, you know how you start picking up the mannerisms of people you surround yourself.

Gillian: [0:07:42.0] Yes, yes, yes.

Interviewer: [0:07:43.0] Just because there's all that to say. But I've started noticing me doing it. And so I kind of almost stop myself. But then I'm like, That's actually a good way of saying that.

Gillian: [0:07:52.0] So yes, yes, yes.

Interviewer: [0:07:54.0] But yes, question, next question. Kind of in the meat of it. So what analytical approach or technique do you generally introduce in this course? So basically, like how do you teach them to analyze data?

Gillian: [0:08:10.0] Okay, so that's kind of in a way a very big question.

Interviewer: [0:08:14.0] Huge question, I'm not going to lie to you.

Gillian: [0:08:15.0] It's all right. It's all right.

Interviewer: [0:08:16.0] It's a huge question.

Gillian: [0:08:17.0] Because I was thinking about that this morning. Because I was thinking about this interview. Yeah. So I was thinking in a way, from the very beginning of the semester, we're thinking about analysis. Um, gosh, I have so much to say on this question. I don't know where to start. But.

Interviewer: [0:08:35.0] Wherever you want.

Gillian: [0:08:37.0] All right.

Interviewer: [0:08:38.0] I'll be here for the ride.

Gillian: [0:08:42.0] Okay. So maybe I'll follow up on that thought first. The thought about, how it's, gosh, what was it, I felt like I had it all clear this morning.

Gillian: [0:08:52.0] I was already.

Interviewer: [0:08:53.0] Well, I'll check the recording device while you think so I'm not looking at you. That helps me a ton.

Gillian: [0:08:58.0] It's still working.

Interviewer: [0:09:00.0] Yup, it's still working.

Interviewer: [0:09:01.0] It didn't mess it up either.

Gillian: [0:09:02.0] Good.

Interviewer: Never stopped.

Gillian: [0:09:03.0] Okay, good.

Interviewer: [colleague] it just got worked. I checked to make sure and then when I did that, I turned it off.

Gillian: [0:09:10.0] No.

Interviewer: That would be great.

Gillian: [0:09:11.0] I've done things like that, I have.

Interviewer: [0:09:12.0] I'm assuming it's going to happen to me at one point, but.

Gillian: [0:09:16.0] Okay, so all right, let me think about like, for example, in terms of how analysis is incorporated into all of the topics as well as just. We have like two classes which are specifically on analysis in [Introduction to Qualitative Research], but I tried to get the idea across from early on that. Well, the idea of emic versus etic, of, that understanding social life isn't just about, it's not just an intellectual process. So it's not like understanding a big mess of statistics or something. It's not the same thing. And so, for example, I just just started doing

this the last couple of semesters, but they do this participatory activity where they ideally it's supposed to happen like this. They're supposed to find someone in the class that has a very different life in some or a very different belief system, or it's just very different in some way or other and participate in an activity with them so that and then take turns so that they get to be insider and outsider. So for example, last semester one person took another person to a tango thing. I mean, the pandemic has made this really difficult.

Interviewer: [0:10:43.0] Oh so they went outside of the classroom?

Gillian: [0:10:45.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:10:46.0] Oh that's awesome.

Gillian: And then someone had someone else, like this was done. They take that, that week outside of class that they do this. So someone took someone for a geo-caching thing and somebody taught somebody to knit. There are a couple of students who cook for each other, so it was a Saudi meal and a Chinese meal. So the idea is to sort of participate in something as an insider and as an outsider to get the idea that we don't just understand things with our brains. We understand them by doing them, being immersed in them, getting, you know.

Interviewer: [0:11:21.0] So that's cool.

Gillian: [0:11:23.0] Yeah. And then there's things you, one understands about one's own culture by introducing someone else to it and then noticing all the weird things about whatever it is that you're doing.

Interviewer: [0:11:35.0] Yeah. There's definitely something there when I have to explicate my process.

Gillian: [0:11:40.0] Yes.

Interviewer: To someone else.

Gillian: [0:11:42.0] Yes.

Interviewer: I realize all the little things.

Gillian: [0:11:44.0] Yes.

Interviewer: [0:11:46.0] Yeah.

Gillian: So and that's part of it, which is my background. But there's this sort of very. This is, this phrase is used over and over and over again. But making the strange, familiar and the familiar strange. So sort of. So I'm kind of trying to introduce that idea directly through doing that. And then the idea of rapport is hugely interest, important, I think. And that's. Also involved in analysis, sort of position taking. So I think that analysis is not just an intellectual thing and it has all these other components to it. And I'm sort of trying to teach that before we get to the actual, before we do observations and before we do interviews. So. But anyway, so the way I can't remember the question. Oh yeah. You said, how do I teach analysis.

Interviewer: [0:12:43.0] Can I ask a question on?

Gillian: [0:12:44.0] Yeah, please.

Interviewer: [0:12:45.0] So it seems like you have your two classes on specific analysis, but it seems like beforehand you're kind of trying to teach them that qualitative analysis is not a process. It's not like a check the box, it's a way of being in the research process.

Gillian: [0:12:59.0] Yeah, that's a beautiful way to say it.

Interviewer: [0:13:01.0] Yeah, I think someone else I think I actually heard that in [professor's] class. It wasn't me.

Gillian: [0:13:04.0] Okay.

Gillian: [0:13:05.0] No, nothing, what I say is new.

Interviewer: [0:13:07.0] But, yeah, that's what it sounded like as a way of being, which I relate to, because I feel that way with qualitative.

Gillian: [0:13:16.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:13:17.0] So yeah.

Gillian: [0:13:18.0] No, that's actually a beautiful phrase. I like it a way of being.

Interviewer: [0:13:24.0] A way of being, qualitatively.

Gillian: [0:13:28.0] Are you a Rogerian?

Interviewer: Am I a what?

Gillian: Do you like Karl Rodgers?

Interviewer: [0:13:30.0] I don't know, I don't think so.

Gillian: [0:13:31.0] He had a book called (inaudible).

Interviewer: [0:13:34.0] Oh, I'll take it.

Interviewer: [0:13:35.0] I'll add it to my list of stacks that I'll read one day this summer. I'm not taking any classes, so hopefully.

Gillian: [0:13:43.0] Okay, so, so back to how I teach. So anyway, so we, we sort of I try and do that in the first few weeks. It's funny, now that you're talking to me. It's hard for me to even remember what I teach, but so then we do observations and then and with and validity and stuff like that, and then we do interviews. And then after that we have these two classes specifically on analysis, and I think that's what you most were interested in.

Interviewer: [0:14:10.0] That's the ones I'm pretty sure we're recording.

Gillian: [0:14:12.0] Okay. All right. So. So one of the things in the first so it seems very, very rushed, just having two classes to do analysis.

Interviewer: [0:14:26.0] 100%. I agree. It feels rushed as a student.

Gillian: [0:14:29.0] Yes, yes.

Gillian: [0:14:31.0] So I realize I can't I mean, I can't do a lot. I can introduce vocabulary and I can introduce some of these different approaches. But also what I want to do partly is to sort of demystify things like coding and themes by showing that they're kind of extensions of what we do in everyday life anyway. They're like, let's say you have an interview or an observation or something. You have to have a way to. I mean, it's this big mass of information and. So coding is a way of just kind of organizing it into chunks so that you can make sense of it.

Interviewer: [0:15:21.0] Is that how you would define coding, organizing into chunks?

Gillian: [0:15:26.0] I have a lot of synonyms. Of course, it depends whether you're doing like a (inaudible) recording or open coding or whatever. But I have a lot of synonyms which I present to the students, like organizing, categorizing, ordering. Which.

Interviewer: [0:15:47.0] That's nice. I like that because coding it is that's demystifying it because that's.

Gillian: [0:15:52.0] Kind of what I want to do, because I feel like people have this fear of it. Like it's this big technical thing. Yeah. Similar to what you do with statistics, which is really.

Interviewer: [0:16:03.0] I have that fear.

Gillian: [0:16:04.0] And then another way I've thought about it, which is especially true of open coding and I sort of emphasize open coding because I think they will learn a prioritized coding, you know, in, in quantitative classes too. It's, it's so I think about so when we're doing interviewing, they learn to paraphrase or they practice paraphrasing and they are, I encourage

them to paraphrase. So I think of coding as sort of listening to the text in the same way, do a little part, a little short paraphrases and trying to stay true to what's being said in the text. So that's um. That's another phrase I use as paraphrasing.

Interviewer: [0:16:55.0] I like it.

Gillian: [0:16:56.0] Okay. Thank you.

Interviewer: [0:16:57.0] I don't know if my opinion matters.

Gillian: [0:16:58.0] It does but you're a very encouraging interviewer.

Interviewer: [0:17:02.0] Oh, thank you. I don't know if I should be or not. We'll see.

Gillian: [0:17:06.0] Yes, you should be.

Gillian: [0:17:08.0] So anyway, that's, that's the start of it. I also think of an analysis and I also say this, I sort of present some basics before we start with things like coding. And one is that. I feel like it's a two way process. So there's you and there's the interview. And if you're like a really strong social constructivist, you sort of say it's all you. But then, you know, what's the point of having the interview there if you're really strong positivist? You'd say, it's all about the interview and you just get enough people to give into your reliability. But I like to think of it as a sort of two way relationship. There's a philosopher called Hans-georg Gadamer, and he has this phrase fusion of horizons, which I really like, because it's sort of the back and forth. It's what you bring to the interview when you're analyzing it. Certain things are going to stand out to you. They're going to move you. They're going to, you know, and then there's the interview itself, you know, that it's there. It's not just something you make up there is somebody there, somebody talking, and they have something to say. And I like the idea that we're listening to that and giving it sort of respect. And I don't know, so I like so I do talk about that two way process. And then after that, after talking about coding, trying to demystify it, then I introduce ways of analysis, but it's really just an introduction. So I introduce, gosh, grounded theory, thematic analysis, narrative analysis, phenomenological, and I've got that. I don't have the book right now, but I have a book called Five Ways of Doing Qualitative Analysis, which is actually way too dense. But so then I used to assign that and because they had like pages and pages and pages of the philosophy and phenomenology, I decided to skip that and I just kind of made it. I do summaries in a PowerPoint of the, of these different ways of doing qualitative analysis.

Interviewer: [0:19:16.0] That's helped me honestly, because the deep readings it's once I have the space. Yeah. Because in the beginning I think it would [professor] discourse analysis. You're going over a whole bunch of different types of discourse analysis and oh man, my brain was on overload. And one of the readings so I think was that of the discursive psychology book had a table and I know we can't we can't bring it down reduce it down to these levels essentially. But it was a nice table.

Gillian: [0:19:47.0] And I could really help. So I sort of give you a place..

Interviewer: [0:19:50.0] to start.

Interviewer: I got to have a place to start. And so I think so you're basically in your course giving your students a place to start is what it sounds like in like five or six.

Gillian: [0:20:01.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: Analysis.

Interviewer: Is there anyone that sticks out the most or do students gravitate towards or do you teach more on or.

Gillian: [0:20:08.0] I really focus more on kind of open coding. Well, okay, this is here's another thought which. One sort thought I, I have had for a long time. Is that there's so much? And this might not be true of disco psychology, which I sort of discourse analysis, which I really am not familiar with.

Interviewer: [0:20:32.0] Taken two courses, that's it.

Gillian: [0:20:36.0] You are a lot more familiar with it than I am.

Interviewer: [0:20:39.0] Currently allow time to pass. You never know.

Gillian: [0:20:40.0] Okay.

Gillian: [0:20:42.0] But what I feel with things like phenomenological analysis, grounded theory, is that in a way they're all trying to do, they're doing very, very similar things. So you have this interview. You're breaking it down into sort of phenomenological analysis we'll call it, meaning units. But basically you're kind of basically summarizing chunks of it, you're breaking it down into a more manageable form so that you can try and see what's going on. Yeah, you're making sense of it. You're summarizing it. So I don't go into the individual types of analysis so much as have them practice like open coding with something. So for example, I've done lots of different things with different classes, but I will have them read something and send me their notes on the side and then maybe kind of grows into broader themes. For one, there was one reading we had called Enrique's journey and it's it's kind of a beautiful book by Sonia Nazario. About the journey of a boy from, it's a real life journey from Honduras to the United States. So I had them look at one chapter and find subheadings like, so they had to come up with ten subheadings. So that was kind of a way of coming up with little clues. And then another thing I've done. God, I just go on.

Interviewer: [0:22:12.0] You're fine. I love it.

Gillian: [0:22:14.0] So theres this one book, yeah Rez Life. There's one chapter of this it's about Indian reservation by a guy who grew up there and this one chapter in here that there's so many different types of power in that chapter. And I had them kind of code for the different types of power.

Interviewer: [0:22:44.0] So you kind of like look at all mediums of life and think of the ways in which your students could learn about coding from them and have them work on it. And whatever that semester is, what you're drawn to is kind of?

Gillian: [0:22:58.0] Yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah. It's a little bit changeable. Let's see, what else have I used? I've also used my own interviews, especially if it's an interview I really like. I think, Wow, this'll be cool to show them this. And then maybe have them do that in class. Just sit there and individually and then in small groups, look at maybe just with two pages of it.

Interviewer: [0:23:24.0] Yeah.

Gillian: [0:23:25.0] And do open coding with that, so.

Interviewer: [0:23:27.0] Because two pages, I'm finding that man, a page can be so rich.

Gillian: [0:23:34.0] Yes.

Interviewer: So rich. I'm overwhelmed, sometimes.

Gillian: [0:23:35.0] Yes. Yes. Actually, two pages. Is probably too much even, yeah.

Interviewer: [0:23:40.0] Sometimes, yeah. We get a, I, in my discursive psychology we have, I think we have two pages, but it is discourse. So I don't, I've done more work in discourse actually at this point than any other field, but so I can't compare it. But I know that a page is a lot.

Gillian: [0:23:56.0] And that's very. I know it has its own system and I don't know what these systems are because I don't.

Interviewer: [0:24:03.0] I kind don't, [colleague] is going to hear this and be like you better. (laughing) I kind of do. But um, yeah. That's really cool though, I like. So it's basically semester by semester if I'm hearing this right. You are looking at life and academic, I don't want to call it academic. I don't even want to call it information, data that exists out in the world, basically.

Gillian: [0:24:32.0] Yeah, I guess I think of I mean, I think of this as qualitative research or maybe this guy is a professor and.

Interviewer: [0:24:41.0] I mean, it could be for sure, but it's definitely not like I'm thinking of like. Oh, I guess what's the distinction that's happening for me is you're allowing them to use other data instead of generating their own data.

Gillian: [0:24:58.0] Oh, yeah, but then they do have their own data as well. So in the observations, we don't do as much with analysis, but when they do the interviews, they have to come up with themes that, you know, themes based on what the other person said rather than on what they came in with or as much as possible.

Interviewer: [0:25:20.0] Yeah.

Gillian: [0:25:21.0] Yeah, yeah. Yeah. And so they do that as well. But we do sort of these practice exercises in class. Um.

Interviewer: [0:25:31.0] How many practices would you say they do on other data before they collect their own with analysis?

Gillian: [0:25:40.0] See? Well, probably just a couple because we only have those two classes, so. Yeah.

Gillian: [0:25:49.0] And then they.

Interviewer: [0:25:50.0] Limited time. Right.

Gillian: [0:25:53.0] And then they do their interviews and let's see, last semester they came into class before they handed the interviews in and kind of bounced their themes of one another to get feedback on them before. Um, and to me, yeah, cool. So I guess that's the third week, but I'm not sure if that counts.

Interviewer: [0:26:17.0] I don't know what counts anymore. I get my weeks confused. Honestly.

Gillian: [0:26:20.0] Yeah, okay.

Interviewer: [0:26:24.0] So I feel like..

Gillian: [0:26:26.0] I'm not sure if I answered you.

Interviewer: [0:26:27.0] I think you did, because. But I just. I want to clarify. I think for you, like this broad idea of coding. Yeah. Broad idea is really the main analysis that you. You teach or technique you teach.

Gillian: [0:26:41.0] Yes.

Interviewer: [0:26:42.0] Okay and how it goes.

Gillian: In terms of practice and in terms of what I want to see on there. Like I want to see on their interviews that they haven't just decided what the interviews about before the person gets the chance to speak, that they are actually listening and trying to sort of summarize what the person say and bring their analysis out of that rather than. And I realize there's a place for the other kind of analysis, too, like maybe if they have a really clear idea ahead of time, what

they're looking for. But, but I want to emphasize this more emergent, open and thematic analysis.

Gillian: [0:27:22.0] I don't like the word emergent.

Gillian: [0:27:24.0] But, this more open set of skills in interviewing and in coding and theming, because I think they'll learn the other skills. Like in other classes.

Interviewer: [0:27:40.0] I won't call the thematic analysis police, so I won't tell them. You told, you said.

Gillian: [0:27:44.0] Okay.

Gillian: [0:27:48.0] Okay. Here's another, here's a frustration I have. Oh, gosh, I don't if I should be saying this either, but I feel like some of these approaches I don't know. I don't think they're intended this way. And I'm thinking here about thematic analysis and grounded theory in particular, but it makes it look so procedural, you know, do this and then do that and then do this. And it almost seems to me with something like thematic analysis, it seems almost kind of inappropriate because, I can't explain what I mean. Like, all right, let's say grounded theory. I feel like all research should be grounded. You know, you don't have to have a special set of procedures.

Interviewer: [0:28:36.0] Yeah.

Gillian: [0:28:39.0] Yeah, with those two it strikes me especially. I've kind of appreciated thematic analysis just because it's basically what you would do anyway, but it's got a label now and your committee is going to be happy with you for doing it, so.

Interviewer: [0:28:51.0] It feels like what you're explaining right now. You combat by teaching analysis as this way of being because you're saying like thematic analysis grounded, like it's already there, it should already be being used, but we've labeled it right. So now we're good.

Gillian: [0:29:08.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:29:09.0] But it seems like you combat that frustration by teaching analysis in such a way that it is just qualitative analysis. Qualitative research is way of being in this way. Like that includes all of these things essentially.

Gillian: [0:29:25.0] Yes, I think that's a fair comment. Yeah. Like I feel like phenomenological experience should be there and everything. You can't really do social research without. Although the structuralist I guess tried to do that. You can't really do it without looking at experience.

Interviewer: [0:29:43.0] Yeah, I experience the same frustrations, but I don't know a ton yet. So I can't really make valid arguments. But I always find myself in class being like, yeah, but isn't that just, isn't that just the way we should be?

Gillian: [0:29:57.0] Yeah, yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: [0:29:59.0] So.

Gillian: [0:30:00.0] But I do appreciate, I do realize that research, if it's going to be research it needs, we, I appreciate all the systems because at least people are being thorough and it's a sort of check.

Interviewer: [0:30:12.0] Which is valid.

Gillian: I think you used the word check

Interviewer: [0:30:13.0] Check the box. Yeah.

Gillian: [0:30:14.0] Yeah. Because it is important to do certain things to make sure that you. I don't know.

Interviewer: [0:30:21.0] Yeah. No. So, like, it's a way of being, but it's also essential that we identify what we're doing so that we can be critiqued.

Gillian: [0:30:27.0] Oh, I love that. You should be. You should be interviewed. Instead of me.

Interviewer: [0:30:31.0] Nope, not, I would be the opposite. I'd be like, blah, blah, blah, blah, blah. I would be horrible depending on the day.

Gillian: [0:30:41.0] So also I have separate topics of validity which actually I'm doing this week, so maybe I should send you that stuff too, I don't know.

Interviewer: [0:30:50.0] Maybe I don't know. I'll ask [colleague], I report up to her, as you can tell. What does [colleague] say?

Gillian: [0:30:56.0] Okay. All right.

Gillian: [0:30:58.0] So I feel like I'm a bit muddled so far, so. But I want to have the vocabulary of all these different types of research. But you're right, that isn't what we do. What we actually do is more sort of open coding.

Interviewer: [0:31:11.0] Yeah. I mean, that's what it sounds like you're saying, which sounds lovely. It sounds. It also sounds manageable to understand because comprehension is also the goal. Yeah. So that sounds because I know my classes. My [introductory qualitative] course was at [institution] and I was like, my brain was spinning.

Gillian: [0:31:37.0] Oh really?

Interviewer: [0:31:38.0] You know, because just all the different approaches, it's a lot, you know, to be in all the different approaches. And so having one segment which it seems like it's this open coding to kind of live around feels stable.

Gillian: [0:31:54.0] Okay. Well, I guess another thing I should say about this [Introduction to Qualitative Research] is that it was always designed, I think, before I came into the program. I think that the people who started the you know, introduced qualitative research like [several faculty colleagues]. They wanted us to do hands on stuff. And so we have to fit into this one semester. We have to fit, you know, real life interviews, real life observations and, and analysis. So and I've always enjoyed teaching the hands on. I enjoy the fact that they get to do the hands on stuff. And I enjoy teaching that. And I love, you know, the practice interviews and the practice observations and all the kind of fun stuff they can do with each other in class. Yeah. So I would rather do that than spend, maybe, of course, I don't really know. But so for me, it sort of works that, you know, we're squeezing the analysis into a pretty short span of time, but.

Interviewer: [0:32:59.0] I still feel I mean, I don't know if I should even be doing this, but I feel like what you've said, though, the way you've articulated it is that you're still teaching analysis before those weeks.

Gillian: [0:33:11.0] Yes.

Interviewer: [0:33:12.0] So.

Gillian: Yes, and that's a beautiful paraphrase thank you very much.

Interviewer: [0:33:15.0] Yeah. I don't know what I'm supposed to do, but I did it. So I'll get critiques if I need it.

Gillian: [0:33:20.0] Yeah, I feel like it's really it does. It comes up all the way through right from the very beginning. The emic and etic thing.

Interviewer: [0:33:29.0] Yeah. You know, I hadn't heard that until I came here.

Gillian: [0:33:32.0] Oh, okay.

Interviewer: [0:33:33.0] And I was like, oh, emic and etic. Oh, these are words I should know. So I appreciate our program focusing on that.

Gillian: [0:33:43.0] Yeah. Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:33:44.0] Oh, cool. Well, I think you answered that question beautifully. Yeah. Unless you have anything more you want to add.

Gillian: [0:33:51.0] No, no, I'm fine.

Interviewer: [0:33:55.0] So. You know, I think you kind of answered my second one, which was tell me about your decision to include this particular analytic strategy or technique in your course. Do you think there's any more you can add on that? You kind of answered it.

Gillian: [0:34:10.0] Should I send you at some point, oh, you're going to come to that class, but I could send you the PowerPoint on that, so you could.

Interviewer: [0:34:17.0] That might be helpful. Yeah. So we have something to. Yeah.

Gillian: [0:34:20.0] And I've tried to just when I'm introducing just basic vocabulary, just the basic this is what it is, this is what people mean when they say that. That's all I'm really doing. Yeah. And I've just tried to stick with approaches I've heard used a lot and grounded theories. One narrative, is one thematic is, so phenomenological.

Interviewer: [0:34:41.0] Have those changed over the years?

Gillian: [0:34:44.0] Thematics been? I've only heard about it in the last maybe three years and suddenly, like, everyone's doing it and.

Interviewer: [0:34:50.0] It's funny how that stuff happens.

Gillian: [0:34:54.0] Yeah. I know.

Interviewer: [0:34:58.0] But you adapt as the years pass.

Gillian: [0:35:00.0] Yes, exactly.

Interviewer: [0:35:01.0] Is that something you do explicitly or is that just kind of like implicit in your lifestyle that you like just because you are emerged in qualitative?

Gillian: [0:35:13.0] Yes, I think to be really honest, what happens like I'll hear something said a lot, then I'll sort of panic and think, oh my God, I'm not teaching my students as I look it up. So it's kind of like that. Like.

Interviewer: [0:35:28.0] I like that. That sounds good. I mean, that sounds real life. It also seems not forceful. It seems emergent.

Gillian: [0:35:38.0] Okay.

Interviewer: [0:35:39.0] Honestly. Yeah, you know, because you're like, oh, this is happening everywhere. Maybe I should focus on.

Gillian: [0:35:43.0] Yes, yes.

Interviewer: [0:35:46.0] Okay, yeah. And then it feels like you already discussed why you, coding is such a big deal. Why you do that? Yeah, but if there's anything else you want to add to that.

Gillian: [0:35:56.0] To the coding thing?

Interviewer: [0:35:57.0] Well and like, why you decide to focus on it compared to anything else,so.

Gillian: [0:36:02.0] I also think note taking is important but so and that I kind of not thought about again, this is just like semester by semester. I said, oh my God, I should have been thinking about that more, but.

Interviewer: [0:36:15.0] If they're going to do qual they're going to take more. So we'll get it eventually.

Gillian: [0:36:21.0] Yeah, yeah. And so so why coding. So is that's a question?

Interviewer: [0:36:27.0] Basically, I think it's like and I, I, from what you've shared, I have, I feel like you have answered why you use coding. Because you feel like it's everywhere, like it's part of everything.

Gillian: [0:36:37.0] Yeah. And because it's a scary word that.

[0:36:40.0] Yeah, demystifying that's what you said.

Gillian: [0:36:42.0] Yeah, yeah. And then when I'm introducing it, so when they're actually practicing they do open coding but when I'm introducing it I just, I give them vocabulary. It's so the PowerPoints is supposed to be a reference thing so they can look back. So we discuss words like a priori coding, open coding, emerging coding, axial coding. And so that these are not, you know, this is just vocabulary. And they're actually say very simple things, not very complex things.

Interviewer: [0:37:12.0] Thank God.

Gillian: [0:37:14.0] Yeah, yeah. So we do go over that in the PowerPoint, too.

Interviewer: [0:37:22.0] And then you said said that the other ones during the analysis week it's just basically to give them an idea of what's out there.

Gillian: [0:37:29.0] Exactly. Exactly.

Interviewer: [0:37:31.0] Just to, so it almost is like you're preparing them to have kind of a basic knowledge of qualitative research analysis and here are the mainstays, currently.

Gillian: [0:37:44.0] Right.

Interviewer: [0:37:45.0] In qual, here's a basic understanding if you want to pursue them further.

Gillian: [0:37:50.0] Yes, yes, yes.

Interviewer: Coding is kind of.

Gillian: [0:37:52.0] That's what we do in practice.

Interviewer: [0:37:53.0] Yeah. And that's, would you say that's like what's the most because you're quantitative too, aren't you?

Gillian: [0:38:01.0] Not really. I do like very, like an introduction to quantitative theory. So quantitative practice.

Interviewer: [0:38:10.0] It's very quantitative to this little one.

Gillian: [0:38:12.0] Really.

Interviewer: [0:38:14.0] I haven't taken stats since like seven years ago, so I'm very scared for my intro.

Gillian: [0:38:20.0] Yeah. No, I mean, we do we just do things like this is called causation, you know, this is what people mean. You know, it's really, really basic because somehow we have to fit all of quantitative and qualitative into one. And that's just crazy.

Interviewer: [0:38:34.0] Yeah, that's crazy.

Gillian: [0:38:35.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:38:37.0] Oh, I was going though. Would you say that like the purpose of demystifying coding is really demystifying it in a qualitative sense and separating them from maybe any quantitative ideas of coding?

Gillian: [0:38:51.0] Yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah because it does seem that we qualitative researchers, me included, are desperately trying to make ourselves look relevant and like, why not just pull things over the air. Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:39:06.0] Valid.

Gillian: Yeah, valid.

Gillian: [0:39:09.0] Yup, yup, [professor's] class.

Gillian: [0:39:10.0] Yes and, and that there is some sort of system, there is some sort of rationale to it. It's we're not just making stuff up. So.

Interviewer: [0:39:17.0] Yeah, and that you just said system and rationale and that makes me think of how you're discussing how you're teaching it, that you want to make sure they understand the systems of like the procedures, even though you know that it's like essential in being, but still also be able to understand your systems.

Gillian: [0:39:33.0] Yeah. Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:39:34.0] Cool. I feel like I'm taking your class.

Interviewer: [0:39:40.0] Okay, god I think you almost answered this, we just kind of had a conversation it feels like.

Gillian: [0:39:44.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: Because I was going to my next question is describe in as much detail as possible how you typically teach these strategies which.

Gillian: [0:39:53.0] Okay.

Interviewer: [0:39:54.0] If you want to add more, but you have definitely given me some already.

Gillian: [0:40:00.0] Let me think, so and again I'm sorry, but so because this complicates things but it does tend to be different from semester to semester.

Interviewer: [0:40:07.0] Yeah. And we could just do last semester.

Gillian: [0:40:09.0] Okay. So the semester I brought it, I remember bringing in an interview which was an interview I did with a caregiver who I found very inspiring. So it was lovely for me to share her interview.

Interviewer: [0:40:22.0] Yeah.

Gillian: [0:40:23.0] So I brought in two pages. They got into small groups, they sort of looked at it individually first, then got together and compared their, those little cold summaries that they come up with. So that was what we did as a practice. They had the PowerPoint on the different types. And then I think the next week they brought in their interviews and then kind of bounce feedback on it for with each other about.

Interviewer: [0:41:02.0] Did they choose a certain type of coding that they were going to do?

Gillian: [0:41:06.0] They just did open coding.

Interviewer: [0:41:08.0] They just did, okay.

Gillian: [0:41:09.0] And oh, also last semester we saw a movie. I think it's a beautiful movie called China's Van Gough's. It's about. It's about these artists in China who sort of mass produce Van Gogh pictures. So when you see, like if you go to a market in Amsterdam and you see lots and lots of copies of, these are painted by these like in really sweatshop

conditions in China. So it was actually a really, really moving movie about. It was made by Chinese people. And this, this and they followed a few characters who were and then these characters decided to go to to Amsterdam and see how their work was being sold. And there was this kind of disheartening movement, you know, moment when they saw this kind of junky little store outside and. And then one of them also got inspired to do his own painting. And he went to his village and painted his grandmother. I don't know. It was just a very, very moving piece of work. So they were in class. They were kind of coming up with codes and things.

Interviewer: [0:42:27.0] That's cool.

Gillian: [0:42:28.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: I like that. That's really interesting. So basically, almost. It would be like observation.

Gillian: [0:42:34.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: But, recorded.

Gillian: [0:42:36.0] Yeah, so, yeah.

Interviewer: [0:42:37.0] Really cool. I would do that in class.

Gillian: [0:42:43.0] Oh that, I think that one, I did it for themes, rather. So it's sort of bigger, you know, bigger themes. Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:42:52.0] And then you had said earlier, when you're going over the broader analysis, the specific types of analysis, it's generally just a PowerPoint. We're just discussing how they how they are. Do you have them do any practice in class.

Gillian: [0:43:03.0] Or with those particular methods? No, because there's there's too many of them. But we. I don't think would. I mean. Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:43:19.0] I don't know how we do all we do in the weeks we do already.

Gillian: [0:43:21.0] Yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: [0:43:22.0] I'm going to double check this is working because again. Yup, sweet. I don't want to be that person, still. I think that pretty much. Is there anything else you want to add?

Gillian: [0:43:34.0] Well, I was just thinking of something else. Sometimes, I'll do columns like I can't remember if we did this last semester. I think I want to do it this semester. But columns like because you could also do self reflective coding so they might have a column for a priori code, things that they're already interested in. That they can keep track of, things that they get from hearing the person talk and then a third column of their own kind of internal processes.

Interviewer: [0:44:07.0] And they did this on their interviews or yours.

Gillian: [0:44:10.0] This would be some material like mine. Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:44:13.0] Okay, so but would you say that, like, do you require them to go a little deeper in analysis when it's not their data or like, does one go like if it is their data, are you asking them to go a little deeper?

Gillian: [0:44:31.0] When it's their data. I don't go to the level that I know [professor] does, you know, high inference and low inference and stuff like that, because we we only have this one semester in which they're supposed to do all the stuff. With their own interviews, the main thing I want to see is that they're true to what the person said and not kind of imposing

some meaning on them, not kind of second guessing them. So, no, I do not, we do not really go into into a great deal of depth.

Interviewer: [0:45:08.0] Well, I mean, you have only a certain amount of time.

Gillian: [0:45:10.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:45:11.0] Time should also be, if we could change the time, what would happen?

Gillian: [0:45:15.0] Yeah, yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: [0:45:17.0] Okay. The next one is, do you find, is there anything at all that you find challenging about teaching analysis? Like, probably coding is mostly what you focus on or maybe even the shortened version of the different types of analysis.

Gillian: [0:45:34.0] Yes. There's lots of stuff I find challenging. I feel like. It's real. It's really. Sometimes challenging, not with everyone, but sometimes challenging to teach the idea that, that analysis isn't purely intellectual, that.

Interviewer: [0:46:05.0] For those quant people.

Gillian: Yeah. The participation itself, that, that way that you put yourself into a situation, you are changed by it. That's a lot, it's difficult something it's what I want to sort of get across because I feel like that's a big part of what distinguishes qualitative research from quantitative.

Interviewer: [0:46:25.0] Yeah.

Gillian: [0:46:27.0] It's these kind of non cognitive aspects of, of analysis, understanding the world. Yeah. So yeah, that's challenging, but it's a challenge I kind of like because I don't know, I think it's cool.

Interviewer: [0:46:42.0] Yeah, it's really cool. That's why I'm here, so.

Gillian: [0:46:44.0] Yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: [0:46:47.0] Is there any, any certain way you've figured over the years to address that challenge? It's like you have somebody really, like, pushing you on the cognitive realm.

Gillian: [0:47:01.0] Yeah. And it's not like I reject that. I see that as important to so. What was the question, sorry.

Interviewer: [0:47:10.0] Oh, what are you. What is it? That is a good question. What is the question? What are some approaches you take when you get challenged?

Gillian: [0:47:19.0] Yes. Okay. What is. I think about well, for example, there there are studies like, I think science. A Journal called Science did a study showing that people who read literature become more empathetic. So I think there's or you can point to examples in history where someone has heard a story like the story of Rosa Parks or the story of Anne Frank or something like that. And that has moved public opinion. So what I want to say by that is just that understanding something on an empathetic level often is what actually pushes change. And it's not the pure intellectual knowledge that pushes change so that it is actually impactful and effectful, effectful?

Interviewer: [0:48:16.0] I'll take it, yeah

Gillian: Okay.

Interviewer: [0:48:18.0] I'm not here to judge on word usage.

Gillian: [0:48:21.0] Okay.

Interviewer: You don't want to see what I type before the spelling check goes through.

Gillian: [0:48:27.0] So, that is, the fact that stories have power. That, um. Understanding on these different levels has power in it, to change the world, to change things.

Interviewer: [0:48:40.0] And I feel like, from what I've heard about you, that you are coming from a feminist critical lens a little bit, right?

Gillian: [0:48:47.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: So it almost sounds like to get them to book it's. To show that qualitative has power basically.

Gillian: [0:48:58.0] Yeah. Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:48:59.0] To effect positive change.

Gillian: [0:49:01.0] Yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: [0:49:03.0] Yes. That's what I believe. I hope everybody believes that. But you know, we kind of touched on this because I think you were touching. It was hard for students, too. But what, if anything at all do students find challenging, within the course.

Gillian: [0:49:18.0] Yeah, I this comes up again and again, this idea of bias and, and I understand that it makes sense because, I mean, history is full of biased research studies that have oppressed people. So, you know.

Interviewer: [0:49:35.0] Valid concern.

Gillian: [0:49:37.0] Exactly. But with qualitative research, it's a little different because you're not trying to make a sort of generalized law. You're, you're presenting a portrait more and. So I think that's something I wish I had better ways to explain. Like why bias isn't quite the same when you're, you know, you're not trying to make a general rule about how. I don't know.

Interviewer: [0:50:10.0] Morals, basically. Yeah.

Gillian: [0:50:12.0] Yeah. I was thinking more of, like, how engines work or something. It's. In which case you may want to make sure you had an absolutely perfect random sample and, you know, because you could so easily make mistakes. But when you're painting a portrait, you're painting a portrait and it's a different thing. You're showing a kind of all this holistic context and you're not trying to replicate something. You're trying to convey a whole world. And it's yeah. So the fact that that is still valid is sometimes it takes a while for me to convince people and I'm not sure I always do either.

Interviewer: [0:51:00.0] I mean, that's a pretty big undertaking.

Gillian: [0:51:02.0] Yeah, yeah, yeah.

Interviewer: [0:51:03.0] So yeah, the next question was how do you typically address the students issues that come up or challenges, which.

Gillian: [0:51:13.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:51:14.0] Pretty much answered that, like trying to paint that picture for them. But that is a challenge.

Gillian: [0:51:20.0] Yeah. And just think about things that have moved them or changed them. You know, it's often it's not a set of numbers, it's, it's some direct experience they had in their life or something like that.

Interviewer: [0:51:33.0] No a 100%.

Gillian: [0:51:34.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:51:35.0] For me, that's why I got into qualitative research was a feeling not.

Gillian: [0:51:39.0] Cool.

Interviewer: [0:51:40.0] Not, not some line drawings pointing to you click these boxes. This is where you should go. I don't think qualitative research is on any of those questionnaires, but you know.

Interviewer: [0:51:52.0] Okay. Oh, how do you determine whether your students have learned how to do? I want to say coding almost because the analysis, coding is really the main one.

Gillian: [0:52:04.0] Right, right, right.

Interviewer: [0:52:05.0] So how do you determine that they've successfully comprehended that.

Gillian: [0:52:10.0] Okay. So they will hand in, well when the online classes. They will send me samples of coding and then I can give some feedback on that. And then the themes from their interviews also like, you know, does this does this really relate to this interview or is it. So, that's pretty basic. I mean, I like I said, I don't go very far with this. I don't go into great depth. So.

Interviewer: [0:52:45.0] So basically it's that they've been able to make it participant oriented.

Gillian: [0:52:52.0] With the interviews, yes. With the coding, yeah. Is it a summary of what the person has actually said or is it. Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:53:09.0] And then if they have then you, they've pretty much gotten how to approach coding, I guess I should say.

Gillian: [0:53:17.0] Yeah. Or to approach.

Interviewer: [0:53:18.0] The broadest.

Gillian: Open, open coding.

Interviewer: [0:53:19.0] So you mean the broadest sense possible.

Gillian: [0:53:20.0] Yeah.

Interviewer: [0:53:21.0] Okay, cool. Well, you've my last question. Yeah. Is there anything else you would like to add?

Gillian: [0:53:34.0] There probably is and I'll remember as soon as you're gone, so.

Interviewer: I can sit for a while.

Gillian: [0:53:40.0] Hmm.

Gillian: [0:53:56.0] Maybe. No, I think I think I've said everything, thank you very much. I've probably gone way over time.

Interviewer: [0:54:03.0] I don't think so. I think 54 minutes.

Gillian: [0:54:07.0] Okay.

Interviewer: It was an hour. I wanted to be cognizant of your time too, so I was like really enjoying it in the beginning. I'm going to stop recording now because you have nothing else to add.

Gillian: [0:54:15.0] I don't think so.